

DR. UCHECHUKWU EFIFIE

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Professional Summary

Result-oriented Senior Public Health Physician and Program Manager with over fourteen (14) years of progressive leadership experience leading public health initiatives and health systems strengthening programs across national and sub-national levels in Nigeria. Demonstrated expertise managing multidisciplinary teams and partners, overseeing financial and programmatic accountability, and integrating specialized health interventions into existing health systems. Extensive experience implementing large, donor-funded initiatives (USAID, CDC-PEPFAR, Global Fund, NHIA), including strengthening state social health insurance enrolment, benefit access, and health care financing for people living with HIV, and driving adaptive management via monitoring, evaluation and learning (MEL) frameworks. Skilled at navigating complex health ecosystems, engaging Government institutions (including Ministries of Health), and guiding Technical Working Groups to drive policy adoption and system change. A people manager recognized for line-managing multidisciplinary teams and driving data-informed decision-making and continuous program improvement for sustainable health systems strengthening.

Core Technical And Leadership Domains

- **Program Leadership & Partner Management:** Sub-grant oversight, multidisciplinary team leadership, and partner capacity building.
 - **Health Systems Integration:** Embedding MNCH, PHC, and HRH into sustainable policies and referral networks.
 - **Financial Oversight & Accountability:** Budget management, expenditure tracking, and strict donor compliance.
 - **M&E & Data Systems:** Performance dashboards, data analytics, and routine data quality assurance (DQA).
 - **Stakeholder Engagement:** Government relations, institutional strengthening, and cross-sector TWG leadership.
 - **Health Care Financing & Insurance:** State Social Health Insurance enrolment, benefit-package alignment, claims linkage, and reduction of out-of-pocket costs for PLHIV and HIV-exposed populations.
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Key Career Achievements

- **Workforce Policy & Expansion:** Leveraged the FCT Annual Health Workforce Profile to secure government approval for recruitment of ~800 new health workers and replacement of 136 staff lost to attrition.
 - **Health Financing & Budget Policy:** Spearheaded development and integration of the FCT's first-ever dedicated Human Resources for Health (HRH) budget into the 2024 Annual Operational Plan (AOP).
 - **National Regulatory & Policy Review:** Partnered with NMCN and CHPRBN to revise and digitize national accreditation systems, Standing Orders, and Clinical Practice Guides.
 - **Government Ownership & Sustainability Financing:** Positioned Delta State as the National Sustainability Model after FMOH N-SHIP readiness assessment, securing a dedicated HIV budget line in the 2023 AOP.
 - **Health Insurance Enrolment for PLHIV:** Advanced multi-stakeholder advocacy for State Government-funded enrolment and benefit-package access for PLHIV under the State Health Insurance Equity Health Plan.
 - **National Survey Execution with FMOH:** Coordinated the NAIIS project across the Southeast zone, managing 300+ field staff to survey 14,140 households within a strict six-month timeline.
 - **Large-Scale Healthcare Scale-Up:** Activated 469 feeder spoke sites and 15 mobile case-finding teams across 15 LGAs, identifying 500+ new cases weekly across the state.
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Work Experience

Regional Program Manager | Independent Evaluators (Consultancy), NHIA North Central Zone, Nigeria | March 2025 - Date

Provides strategic regional leadership for maternal and neonatal (MNCH) quality improvement across 44 tertiary and secondary hospitals, driving CEmONC and the Free Fistula Program (special financial-access programs).

- **Health Financing Alignment:** Engage Hospital Management Boards, State Health Insurance Schemes and facility leadership to align quality of care with financing, including claims standardization.
- **Quality Improvement Monitoring:** Apply clinical audit tools, protocols and performance dashboards to strengthen adherence to care standards.
- **Partner Management:** Manage 4 partnering HMOs on timelines and quality of claims processing per SOPs and MOUs.
- **Achievement:** Collate and analyse complex maternal-health and claims data, conduct root-cause analyses, and implement evidence-based improvements for 3,000+ beneficiaries; facilitated a Niger State policy change mandating Maternal & Perinatal Mortality Review.

State Program Coordinator | Banyan Global (USAID HWM), Abuja, Nigeria | February 2024 - February 2025

Lead portfolio manager for the FCT, providing oversight for health workforce investments, governance, workforce planning, pre-service education and HRIS strengthening.

- **Achievement - Workforce Policy:** Led advocacy and the FCT Annual Health Workforce Profile, securing approval to recruit ~800 new health workers and replace 136 staff.
- **Achievement - HRH Budget:** Guided the HRH TWG to integrate the FCT's first dedicated HRH budget into the 2024 AOP and transitioned the TWG to a state-owned mechanism.
- **Achievement - HRIS:** Operationalized iHRIS 4.3 to 5.0, built HRH analytics capacity, and optimized deployment of 138 Midwives Service Scheme personnel, raising skilled-birth-attendance from 63% to 90%.

State Program Manager | ECEWS (US-CDC SPEED Project), Delta State, Nigeria | October 2022 - February 2024

Managed a large-scale, donor-funded (\$1.1M) health system program across 56 facilities, 13 sub-grantees and multiple grant lifecycles.

- **Health Insurance for PLHIV:** Partnered with the Delta State Contributory Health Insurance Commission to strengthen enrolment pathways and reporting linkages, reducing out-of-pocket costs.
- **Subgrantee Management:** Managed SLAs, budgets and MOUs for 13 subgrantees ensuring financial accountability and donor alignment.
- **Workforce Leadership:** Directed 400+ staff across integrated HIV, TB and NCD programs.
- **Achievement:** Positioned Delta State as the National Sustainability Model, securing a 2023 AOP HIV budget line and State-funded PLHIV enrolment.

Deputy State Program Manager | CIHP (PEARL Project), Lagos State, Nigeria | April 2021 - September 2022

Provided day-to-day oversight of technical and program execution; line-managed 90 full-time and 384 ad-hoc staff across 9 LGAs.

- **Achievement:** Sustained a 97% viral-suppression rate across 76,000+ clients through data-driven course corrections; activated Community PMTCT across 36 Traditional Birth Attendants.

Senior Program Specialist, Clinical Services (Sub-Office Team Lead) | Caritas Nigeria (4GATES Project), Delta State | December 2019 - April 2021

Managed operations and multidisciplinary teams in the Warri region; developed M&E frameworks across 25 LGAs.

- **Achievement:** Activated community mobile teams across 25 LGAs (incl. riverine areas) identifying 500+ new cases weekly; coordinated 469 feeder spoke sites.

Regional Senior Technical Officer, Prevention, Care & Treatment | ECEWS (Global Fund Project), South-East Zone | August 2019 - December 2019

Provided zonal strategic direction and strengthened M&E across 12 comprehensive sites; recruited, trained and supervised 84 Case Managers across Abia and Imo States.

State Team Lead (Consultancy) | CCCRN, Enugu State | June 2019

Represented the organization with SPHCDA, NPHCDA and FMOH; trained enumerators on vaccine stock count and validation using Open Data Kit (ODK); coordinated statewide stock counts and closeout reporting.

Sub-Zonal Coordinator, Field Implementation | UMB-MGIC (NAIIS Project), Southeast Zone | April 2018 - May 2019

Coordinated the Nigeria AIDS Indicator and Impact Survey; recruited, trained and managed 320 field staff to complete data collection for 14,140 households using CAPI within 6 months.

State Technical Lead | CIHP (CDC Project), Kogi State | March 2015 - April 2018

Led multidisciplinary teams; trained 700+ staff and scaled HIV services to 12 comprehensive facilities, 50 PHCs and 18 private facilities.

State Clinical Services Officer | CIHP (CDC Project), Kogi State | January 2014 - February 2015

Supervised teams across 194 health facilities, institutionalizing integrated HIV services and reporting.

Senior State Clinical Services Associate | CIHP (CDC Project), Kogi State | May 2013 - January 2014

Led the ART team; provided capacity building and developed training materials and job aids.

Clinical Services Associate, Paediatrics | CIHP (CDC Project), Kaduna State | January 2013 - May 2013

Supported expansion and quality integration of paediatric ART services.

Education

- MSc Data Science - Rome Business School, Rome, Italy | September 2025
 - MPH, Public Health - University of the Western Cape, Cape Town, South Africa | 2017
 - MBBS, Medicine & Surgery - Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka, Nigeria | 2007
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Selected Certifications And Professional Development

- Project Management Professional (PMP), Project Management Institute - In view (June 2026)
 - Project Management in Global Health, University of Washington - 2020
 - Diploma in Project Management, Alison - 2017
 - Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate, Google - 2026
 - ALX Data Engineering, ALX Africa - In progress
 - **Human Resources for Health: Principles and Practices**, RTC for Health Research - 2024
 - Biostatistics in Public Health, Johns Hopkins University - 2022
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Projects & Publications

Akpan-Etuk, F. B., Vincent, E. C., Nwanya, E., Efifie, U. E., Alawode, S. O., et al. (2024). HIV Status Disclosure and Treatment Adherence Amongst Support Group Members in Mushin LGA, Lagos State. *International Journal of HIV/AIDS Prevention, Education and Behavioural Science*, 10(1), 29-37.

Oral Presentation - Prevalence of anaemia in newly diagnosed adults infected with HIV in Kogi State, Nigeria. ICASA, Cote d'Ivoire, 2017.